

Quick comment on Friday's late sell-off

Conclusion

It is hard to explain why STAN's \$3bn market sell off late Friday is warranted. Whilst the headlines are unhelpful and would appear to engage the bank in US politics to a certain extent, the existing fact pattern is that, since 2012, every attempt by Brutus Trading to pursue claims against STAN in US courts have been rejected (for instance see [here](#)). In the absence of new facts, we would argue that US litigation risk on this matter remains limited. We remain buyers of STAN with a 1640p price target.

Detail

Standard Chartered lost \$3bn of market cap in late trading on Friday after US Representative Elise Stefanik requested that the US attorney general probe the bank over alleged terrorist payments. Stefanik said that an unspecified case against Standard Chartered was due to expire on 19 August and urged action before that date.

The circumstances surrounding this case are not new - the so-called Brutus Trading case has been around since 2012. The company noted in a [statement](#) that the reporting around this case contains "*profound factual inaccuracies*" and that the "*underlying allegations – including the claim that there are \$9.6 billion in unlawful transactions – are entirely false and have been rejected by the US courts multiple times. We expect the dismissal of this case will continue to be upheld on appeal.*"

Whilst it is unhelpful that the bank appears to be wrapped up in US politics the facts are that the US DOJ has repeatedly declined (over various administrations) to intervene in this case including in 2012, 2017, 2019 (when the DOJ moved to dismiss Brutus's complaint). In 2024, there was also a petition for writ of certiorari filed with the US Supreme Court which was [denied](#).

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FIRST VIEW

RATING	BUY
PRICE	1,305.50p*
PRICE TARGET % TO PT	1,640.00p +26%
52W HIGH-LOW	1,433p - 734p
FLOAT (%) ADV MM (USD)	81.1% 109.45
MARKET CAP	£31.1B \$42.2B
TICKER	STAN LN

*Prior trading day's closing price unless otherwise noted.

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Standard Chartered PLC

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Company Valuation/Risks

Standard Chartered PLC

We value STAN using a Gordon Growth methodology and apply a 12% Ke & 2% growth rate to our ests. Risks to our positive stance include a meaningful deterioration in revenues or drastic deterioration in the credit backdrop.

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Recommendation Published

August 17, 2025 13:27 P.M.

Recommendation Distributed

August 17, 2025 13:27 P.M.

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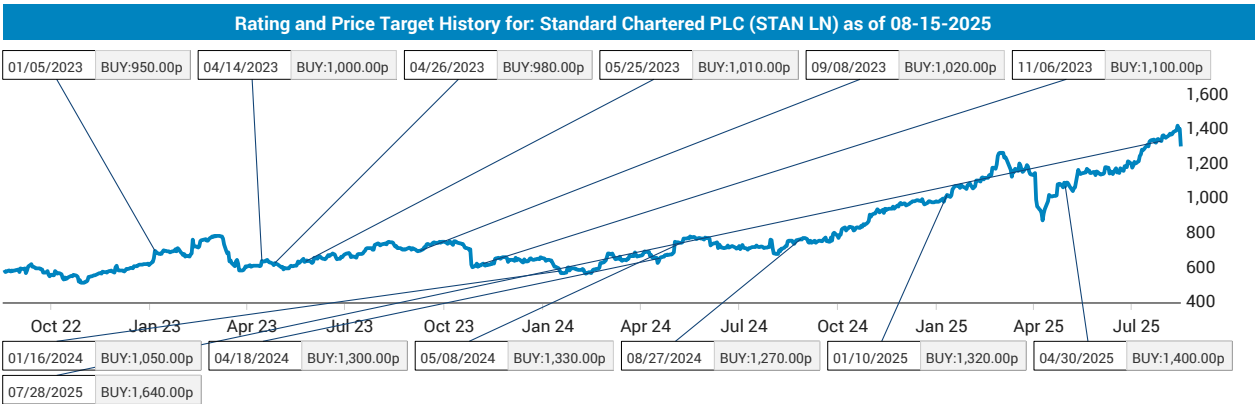
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Other Companies Mentioned in This Report

- Standard Chartered PLC (STAN LN: p1,305.50, BUY)



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Legend:

I: Initiating Coverage

D: Dropped Coverage

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Distribution of Ratings			IB Serv./Past12 Mos.		JIL Mkt Serv./Past12 Mos.	
	Count	Percent	Count	Percent	Count	Percent
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